

CYBR Z Technical Challenge #01

READ THIS FIRST

Welcome to your first CYBR Z technical challenge.

This is not a passive exercise. You will connect to an individual technical environment, review multiple sources of evidence, make an initial security judgement and defend your reasoning.

Before You Begin

You will receive a personal WireGuard configuration file separately.

That configuration is assigned only to you.

- Do not share it with another participant.
- Do not upload it to a shared drive, repository or group chat.
- Do not modify the assigned VPN address or peer settings.
- If you believe your configuration has been exposed, contact the CYBR Z team before continuing.

Required Tools

Please have the following available:

- WireGuard
- Wireshark
- A text editor or spreadsheet application
- A PDF reader

No vulnerability scanner or exploitation framework is required.

Lab Boundary

Your authorised scope is limited to:

- Your assigned CYBR Z VPN connection
- The designated CYBR Z internal lab service
- The evidence supplied as part of Challenge #01

Do not:

- scan the network or other hosts
- perform vulnerability scanning
- brute-force credentials
- attempt exploitation
- test SSH or RDP access
- establish persistence
- disrupt services
- attempt to access systems outside the identified challenge environment

The objective is investigation and security reasoning, not exploitation.

Evidence Integrity

The initial evidence package contains E01-E07 and a SHA256SUMS.txt file.

Before starting your analysis, verify that the evidence has not changed.

On macOS or Linux:

```
shasum -a 256 -c SHA256SUMS.txt
```

All seven evidence files should return:

```
OK
```

If verification fails, stop and contact the CYBR Z team.

Time Standard

Absolute event timestamps in the challenge evidence use UTC.

Some evidence may explicitly describe a person's normal behaviour or statements using local time. Where a source says "local time", treat it as local context rather than converting it as an event timestamp.

Challenge Flow

1. Connect using your individual VPN configuration.
2. Confirm that the designated internal lab service is reachable.
3. Review E01-E07.
4. Build your timeline and initial hypothesis.
5. Decide whether the activity appears Legitimate, Suspicious or Compromised.
6. Record your confidence level and the evidence supporting your decision.
7. Be prepared for additional evidence to be released later.
8. Reassess your position when new evidence becomes available.
9. Finish with your security architecture and response recommendation.

Do not assume that a successful VPN connection means the activity is trustworthy.

One Question to Keep in Mind

The tunnel is up.

Are we safe?